Crisis Management & Brand Recovery

- Vulnerable Destinations
- Crises as Brand Events

Situational Crisis Communication Theory (SCCT)

- Typologies – victim, accidental, preventable
- Match communication strategy to perceived responsibility

Image Repair Theory (Benoit)

- Strategies – denial, evasion, reducing offensiveness, corrective action, mortification

Narrative Reframing

- Help visitors ‘make sense’ of what happened
- Crisis to resilience
- Emotional storytelling

Crisis Life-cycle

- Pre-crisis
- Crisis Response
- Recovery
- Long-term renewal

Pre-crisis

- Preparedness
- Scenario planning
- Risk mapping

Crisis Response

- Safety messaging
- Media management
- Stakeholder coordination

Crisis Recovery

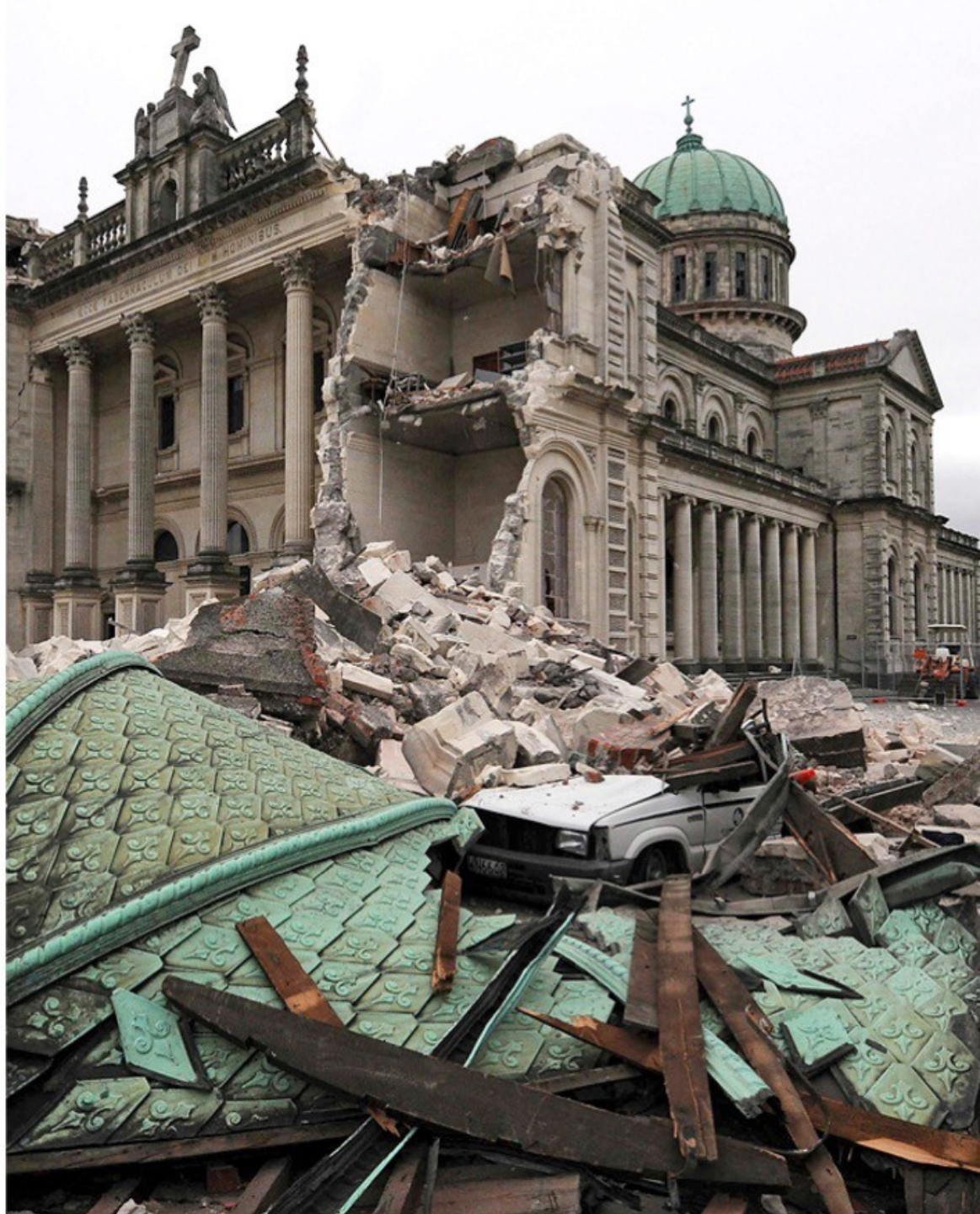
- Brand rebuilding
- Narrative reframing
- Targeted campaigns

Long-term Renewal

- Policy changes
- Infrastructure upgrades
- Memorialisation

Christchurch Earthquake - 2011

- City centre destroyed
- Transparent communication
- Re:START mall
- Creative regeneration
- Physical recovery symbols



Iceland Volcano Eruption (2010)

- Volcanic ash grounds air travel
- 'Inspired by Iceland' campaign during crisis
- Global storytelling moment
- Proactive & resonant

Thailand Tsunami (2004)

- Safety upgrades
- Memorialisation
- Community-centred messaging
- Brand re-framing
- Preparedness & Remembrance

Egypt Political Unrest (2011-13)

- Arab Spring, unrest, security concerns
- Inconsistent messaging
- Slow recovery
- DMO communication lacking

Australia Bushfires (2019-20)

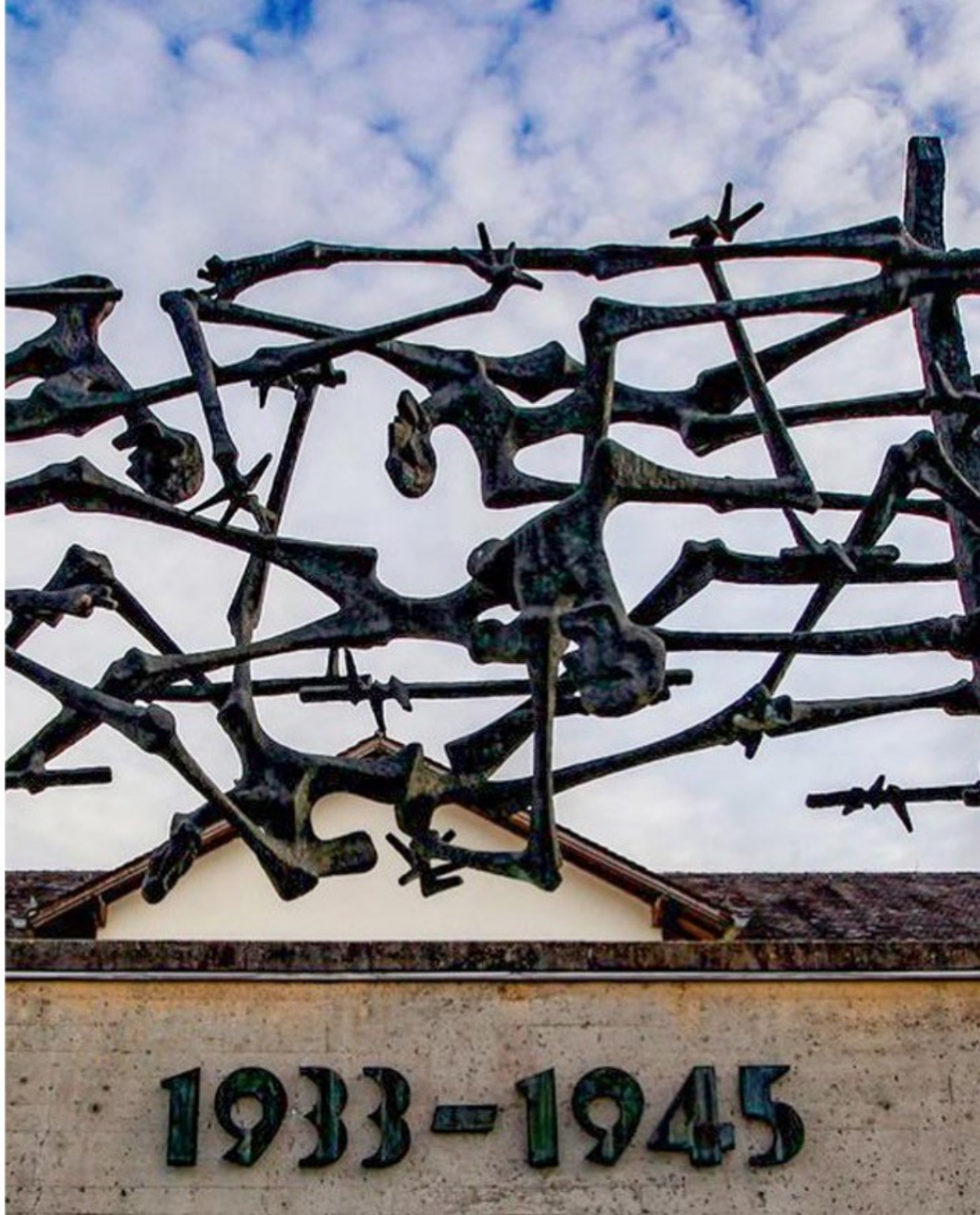
- 'Holiday Here this Year' campaign
- Celebrity-led fundraising
- Community-first messaging builds authenticity

Dubai (2026)

- What would we recommend?

Brand Recovery

- Reassurance, safety protocols
- Symbolic actions, re-opening ceremonies
- Influencer partnerships
- Sequencing, local, domestic, international
- Re-design opportunities

Ethics & Sensitivity

- Avoid ‘Disaster Tourism’ exploitation
- Respect local trauma
- Flow benefits to the affected communities